

First Industry Role - Specification

Company Size

A set chain of command, so I have consistency in terms of managers (who I report to) and someone I can learn directly from. For my current company, this changes every few weeks based on my audit bookings and I would like to work for a closer-knit company, as currently I work for a company with over 700 people in one office which can be very busy and noisy, including a corporate audit team which exceeds 100+ people.

I also want the person I report directly to, to be in the office in which I am working in and not work in a different office or abroad. If I am required in the office, I also want them to be in the office so that I can directly learn from them, especially in my starting months at a new firm.

The only companies I am avoiding in terms of size currently are start up entities – my preference is to work for a mature firm which provides job security and consistent revenue with the ability to continue to grow. Start-ups I am not looking at currently due to the increased risk, and as this is my first industry job, I am looking for a role which is more well defined and constructed as opposed to a start-up role which could be quite loose and undefined.

Industry

I am flexible in this regard. I have spent a lot of time at my current audit practice working on luxury retirement villages and media production/distribution, particularly regarding newsprint, and exposure to investment property and legal clients. I have no immediate preference as to the type of industry to go to.

As my current experience, especially the last 2.5-3 years, has been dedicated to Corporate Audit, I am only looking to work for a corporate company, as opposed to a not-for-profit company.

The only industry I am unlikely to be suitable for is companies in the financial services sector, as all job specifications I have seen to date have requested audit experience/exposure to financial derivatives, interest rate swaps, hedging etc, which I have no direct experience with.

Job Nature

In terms of my preferred job role, I would like to work within management accounting, followed by financial accounting or commercial accounting. Management accounting is my preferred choice due to the exposure to both year end and monthly accounting, adding job variety but also greater attention to detail/analysis.

I would like to avoid internal audit, as I am looking to leave audit and try something new in my first industry-based role. FP&A I am tentative on.

A key aspect of the job role is I do not want it to be too niche, or specialised. A role which offers plenty of variety and involvement in the day to day will help me best in my first move in industry. I am aiming to not bottleneck myself immediately.

Location

London – ideally their office is contained within the boundary of the Circle Line, as this is easy to navigate and not overly time consuming in terms of journey time to and from the office, I currently commute from Coulsdon South, so an office on the Thameslink line would work extremely well. I can get to both London Bridge and London Victoria on a direct train.

Trains – Thameslink I can also get directly down to places such as Crawley, Gatwick, Three Bridges etc, so these also work well.

Car – I have held a clean driving licence for 9 years so can commute to an office by car if needs be.

West – ideally Cobham/junction 10 of the M25 is my limit due to the heavy traffic that operates clockwise on the M25 in the morning. Areas such as Leatherhead, Redhill, Reigate, Dorking, Croydon etc all work well.

East – I can get to Kent easily, roughly Bluewater and surrounding areas is an acceptable distance.

South – places like Crawley, Gatwick etc work well via car as well as train.

Hybrid

I am flexible with the number of days in the office, whether it is 3/2 or 4/1. I am also comfortable with 5/0 but would rather have an element of flexibility, whereby if I need to work from home on a particular day, or start and finish work slightly earlier/later, then I am able to do so.

One key element of a new role is I want to have my own desk and not have to hot desk and change desks each working day.

Salary

I am seeking a role paying a minimum of £65,000 per annum, pre any bonuses. I am currently not considering any roles which are below this threshold.